



Student Handbook AUGUST 2026



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SECTION - I

PREAMBLE, SHORT TITLE,
COMMENCEMENT AND APPLICATION

ABOUT UNIVERSITY

Vidyashilp University is the culmination of an outstanding legacy of the Vidyashilp Education Group, committed to excellence in education. Vidyashilp University aims to foster an environment and culture of collaboration, responsiveness, high performance and service. We are people-centred and have a strongly desire to provide a unique Vidyashilp Experience to our students and staff, focused on nurturing students who will become self-aware, confident, empathetic and resourceful leaders who will serve society to the best of their abilities.

The VU Experience fosters a climate for collaboration between individuals and groups from diverse cultures and backgrounds. VU creates a diverse, inclusive community and environment where VU faculty, staff, students and parents, and alumni feel connected to one another by a common sense of purpose, pride, and spirit, and develop a distinctive ability to work, learn, lead and serve in diverse contexts.

VU's primary educational goal is the cultivation of deep domain knowledge within each student's chosen field. We believe that investing in all domains of our differentiated focus areas is essential to create intellectual capital to drive progress and achieve excellence. At VU, our schools don't function in silos but rather with an interdisciplinary dependence. We focus on a problem-solving approach and provide program choices across all four schools with a curriculum established in Data Science, Digital Business, Design Studies, Legal Studies and Liberal Arts.

VISION, MISSION AND CORE VALUES

OUR VISION

We aspire to provide meaningful, collective learning experiences that result in conscientious leadership for a progressive, yet sustainable society.

OUR MISSION

- We inspire people locally, nationally and globally by extending access to Vidyashilp University's innovative teaching and resources through inclusive and flexible opportunities to study and research.
- To develop human values and human potential to its fullest extent so that intellectually capable and imaginatively gifted leaders can emerge in a range of professions.

OUR VALUES

INTEGRITY – We embrace integrity as a central value in all aspects of personal and professional engagement – including learning, teaching, governance and service – to instil a culture of trust and accountability.

ACADEMIC FREEDOM – We affirm the principles of academic freedom for both students and teachers, their rights and responsibilities to advance knowledge through research and creativity, and to educate students to develop their own independence of mind.

DIVERSITY, EQUITY AND INCLUSION – We assert that diversity and interplay of differences is essential to educational excellence and to enrich the individual and collective learning experiences.

Short Title, Commencement and Application

- a. These Regulations shall be called Academic Regulations.
- b. They shall come into force with immediate effect.
- c. The Academic Regulations are applicable to all existing Degree and Diploma Programs of the University. Any amendments made therein, shall also be applicable to new Degree and Diploma Programs that may be offered by the University in the future.
- d. Specific aspects of the Regulations pertaining to a particular Degree Program are given separately along with the concerned Program Regulations.
- e. These Regulations may evolve and get amended or modified or changed through appropriate approvals from the Academic Council, from time to time, and shall be binding on all concerned.
- f. Additional Regulations, if any, prescribed by the Regulatory / Statutory Bodies for a particular Degree Program shall be included in the concerned Program Regulations.

Definitions

In these Regulations, unless the context otherwise requires:

- a) “Academic Calendar” means the schedule of academic and miscellaneous events as approved by the Academic Council;
- b) “Academic Council” means the Academic Council of the University;
- c) “Academic Regulations” means the Academic Regulations of the University;
- d) “Academic Term” means a Semester or Summer Term;
- e) “Act” means the Vidyashilp University Act, 2020;
- f) “Board of Governors” means the Board of Governors of University as specified by the Act;

- g) “Board of Management” means the Board of Management of University as specified by the Act;
- h) “BoS” means the Board of Studies of a particular School / Department / Program of the University;
- i) “Clause” means duly numbered Clauses of these Regulations;
- j) “Course” means, a specific subject usually identified by its Course number and Course title, with specified credits and a Course Plan, taught by some teacher(s)/Course-instructor(s) to a specific class (group of students) during a specific academic term/semester;
- k) “Course Instructor” means, the teacher/faculty member or the Course instructor of a Course;
- l) “Dean” means the Dean of School / Centre of the University;
- m) “Degree Program” includes all Degree Programs;
- n) “Program Chair” means the Program Chair / Head of the Department / School within the University;
- o) “PAC” means, the Program Academic Committee of a concerned Program of Study of the University;
- p) “Program Regulations” means the Program Regulations governing a specific Degree Program offered by the University, and includes the set of Program-Specific Regulations, Program Structure and Curriculum;
- q) “Program Structure and Curriculum” means the components of the Program Curriculum, Courses with Credits and the mandatory minimum credits to be earned in each component for the award of the degree;
- r) “Registrar” means the Registrar of the University;
- s) “Registrar (Evaluation)” means the Registrar (Evaluation) of the University;
- t) “School/Department” means a constituent School / Department / Centre of the University established for monitoring, supervising and guiding, teaching, training and research activities in broadly related fields of studies;
- u) “Section” means duly numbered Sections of these Regulations;
- v) “Statutes” means the Statutes of Vidyashilp University;
- w) “Sub-Clause” means duly numbered Sub-Clauses of these Regulations;
- x) “Summer Term” means an additional academic term conducted during the summer break (typically in June-July) for a duration of about eight (08) calendar weeks;
- y) “University / VU” means Vidyashilp University; and
- z) “Vice Chancellor” means the Vice Chancellor of the University.

SECTION - II

ADMISSION RULES, FEE POLICY, AND SCHOLARSHIP POLICY

1 ADMISSION

Admission to the University shall be open to all persons irrespective of caste, class, creed, gender, abilities, or nationality. All admissions shall be made on the basis of merit in the qualifying examinations and as per the rules and guidelines prescribed by the Government of Karnataka, other concerned regulatory bodies and the entrance examinations conducted by the University.

The students shall be admitted to a Program subject to fulfilment of eligibility criteria, as prescribed by the University for the respective Program.

A student admitted to a Program of study, shall continue to remain registered for such a Program, till they successfully complete the Program or withdraw from the Program in accordance with the concerned Program Regulations.

Every student duly admitted to the University for a Program after compliance with prescribed formalities and payment of prescribed fees as applicable and other amounts and submission of prescribed documents and certificates shall be allotted a University Enrolment Number **OR** UEN.

If a student fails to pay the University Fee, or fails to produce all the mandatory documents and certificates required for admission to the University before the prescribed last date, the Provisional Offer of Admission to the student shall stand withdrawn.

If a student desires to join the University on the basis of Lateral Entry or Transfer of Credits from other Institutes/Universities during the Program, they shall be examined for eligibility for admission as per the procedure and criteria laid down in the Academic Regulations of the University and the concerned Program Regulations, and admission shall be dependent on their eligibility so determined.

Confirmation of admission and enrolment in the University is subject to fulfilment of the eligibility criteria.

2 FEE POLICY

- a. The University fee consists of components such as Tuition Fee, Security Deposit (Refundable), Examination Fee, Convocation Fee and such other components as may be prescribed by the Board of Management from time to time.
- b. Every program of the University has a prescribed University Fee. Further the Fee Structure and the payment schedule for the entire duration of the concerned program is announced by way of notification before the commencement of each academic year.
- c. The Tuition Fee always means the Annual Tuition Fee for an academic year for a program. The Annual Tuition Fee does not include the expenses / charges for extra-curricular activities, local / international educational trips and other value-added programs that may be introduced from time to time.

- d. The Security Deposit is a Refundable Security Deposit without any interest, subject to deduction of outstanding dues if any, after the student graduates from the program or discontinues from the program or for whatever the reason(s).
- e. The Payment Schedule of the University Fee must be strictly adhered to, by all the students. Failure to comply shall result in the student not being eligible for registration to the concerned academic year and late fee will be charged accordingly. Further, the students are cautioned that this could lead to the loss of an academic year.
- f. Vidyashilp University shall not be obliged to send any reminders for payment of the University Fee. If it is done, it is only in the interest of students and cannot be demanded or referred to in the event of failure to pay the University Fee as per the specified schedule.
- g. The University Fee Structure is subject to change from time to time and shall be notified by the University. The University's decision regarding changes in fee structure is final and binding on all concerned.

3 PAYMENT OF UNIVERSITY FEE

- a. For Students who seek admission directly in the University:

Students who seek admission directly for a specific program in the University shall be notified of the prescribed University Fee and schedule of payment for first year and subsequent years in the Provisional Admission Letter. Failure to remit the fee as per the specified payment schedule or commencement of each academic year, shall result in the forfeiture of admission to the program and applicability of late fee accordingly as decided by the University time to time.

- b. For General Students admitted through CET of Government of Karnataka:

- [i] The Fee Structure (Engineering Fee Structure for CET Fee) for students admitted through CET shall be as notified by the Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA). First year's tuition fee shall be remitted to the CET-KEA at the time of counselling / seat selection.
- [ii] On reporting to the University for confirmation of admission to the concerned program, the student shall also remit "other fees" as notified by the University from time to time.
- [iii] Subsequent years' tuition and other fees shall be remitted directly to the University on or before the notified last date. Failure to remit "other fees" notified by the university, shall result in the forfeiture of admission to the program and charge of the late fee as may be prescribed.

- c. For category (SC/ST/others as specified by KEA) students admitted through CET of Government of Karnataka:

- [i] The Fee Structure (Engineering Fee Structure for CET Fee) for students admitted through CET shall be as notified by the Karnataka Examinations Authority (KEA).
- [ii] On reporting to the University for confirmation of admission to the concerned program, the student shall remit “other fees” as notified by the University.
- [iii] Further, such student(s) shall compulsorily require to apply for/renew the Scholarship as notified by the Government of Karnataka. Upon receipt of scholarship from the Government of Karnataka, such Student(s) shall promptly remit the scholarship amount towards the fee to the University within five (05) working days on receipt of the scholarship from the Government of Karnataka.

It is the sole responsibility of the student(s) to comply with the norms for payment of Fee within the stipulated time. Failure to pay the University Fee / scholarship amount as per the specified schedule shall result in (i) the student being declared ineligible for registration to the term end exams, which could result in loss of an academic year; (ii) levy late fee for late remittance(s); (iii) in case of SC/ST/OBC students, a Report will be sent to the Government of Karnataka about non-remittance of scholarship amount to the University towards the fee and misuse of the same.

4 PAYMENT PROCEDURE

- a. All fee payments should necessarily be made online only using the login credentials of the fee portal as instructed by the University from time to time.
- b. The Fee is payable in INR only
- c. The University will not accept Cash, DD and Cheque.
- d. The digital receipt will be generated by the online system subject to realization of payments.
- e. All statutory taxes / government levies, convenience charges and bank charges pertaining to inward remittance of any fee, if any, shall be borne by the payer.
- f. The University shall not be responsible for any fee amount returned to the payer (Student) without being credited to Vidyashilp University bank account. In such cases, late fee as may be prescribed shall be applicable till the date of receipt of the fee by Vidyashilp University.
- g. It shall be the sole responsibility of the student to ensure that the fee payment process is completed within the specified time.

In case a student is required to repeat/re-register for an Academic Year, the Annual Fee payable by her/him shall correspond to the Academic Year to be repeated, and shall be as per the Fee Policy in force at that point of time.

The policies relating to the University Fee and Deposits, where applicable, are the prerogative of Vidyashilp University and may be revised by the University from time to time. Such changes shall be binding on all concerned.

5 FEE CONCESSION AND SCHOLARSHIP POLICY

Introduction:

Vidyashilp University is committed for providing the best education opportunities to motivated students. The University has established various categories of scholarships to encourage and enable students to pursue education at Vidyashilp University.

Scholarships are provided to reward and support meritorious and talented students, who have demonstrated exceptional performance in academics, sports and co-curricular activities. The University is particularly committed to enabling meritorious students with financial constraints, differently abled students and achievers at the state and national levels, through appropriate scholarships.

5.1 Categories of Scholarships

To cater to the different needs and circumstances of meritorious students, the University offers four (04) categories of Scholarships.

5.1.1 Merit-based Scholarship at the time of Admission

Merit scholarships are awarded to students with outstanding academic performance. This scholarship is awarded at the time of admission to the 1st year of a program.

Two (02) sub-categories of Merit Scholarships are offered:

5.1.2 Outstanding achievement in State / National / International Level Entrance Examinations:

This Scholarship is awarded based on the performance in the State / National / International Level Entrance Examinations specified for a particular program.

5.1.3 Meritorious Performance in the Qualifying Examination:

The Scholarship is awarded based on the performance in the Qualifying Examinations (State / National / International Boards). The details of the extent of scholarship and the corresponding eligibility criteria are as per the scholarship policy and subject to approval by the Scholarship Committee.

5.2 Enabling Scholarship

The University is committed to ensure that a meritorious student is not hindered from pursuing education at Vidyashilp due to financial constraints.

Three (03) sub-categories of enabling scholarships are offered:

5.2.1 Low Income Based Scholarship

This scholarship is offered to enable meritorious students whose family income is a constraint to meet the tuition fees of the program.

5.2.2 Single Parent (Mother) Income Based Scholarship.

This Scholarship is specifically offered to a student with Single Parent (Mother) having financial constraints to pursue education at Vidyashilp.

5.2.3 Ex-Service Parent Income Based Scholarship

This scholarship is offered to a meritorious student whose parent (father/mother) is an ex-service personnel with financial constraints.

The definition of ex-service is specific to commissioned/non-commissioned staff of the Armed Forces and staff of the Central/State Police Services.

5.2.4 The details of the extent of scholarship and the corresponding eligibility criteria are as per the scholarship policy and subject to approval by the Scholarship Committee.

5.3 Encouragement Scholarship

This scholarship is awarded to recognize and encourage students who have excelled in various sports / culture / fine arts/ sciences and have participated / been awarded at State/ National / International levels.

The University is also committed to encourage differently-abled students to pursue education at Vidyashilp University.

Two (02) sub-categories of Encouragement Scholarships are offered:

5.3.1 Scholarship for Outstanding performance in the fields of Sports/Culture/Fine Arts/Sciences.

5.3.2 Scholarship for Differently-Abled.

5.3.3 The details of the extent of scholarship and the corresponding eligibility criteria are as per the scholarship policy and subject to approval by the Scholarship Committee.

5.4 Academic Performance Scholarship (During the Program)

To reward and motivate excellence in overall academic performance, scholarships are awarded to the selected outstanding students during the program i.e., from 2nd Year onwards. The details of the extent of scholarship and the corresponding eligibility criteria are as per the scholarship policy and subject to approval by the Scholarship Committee.

5.5 General Terms and Conditions

- a) All types of Scholarships shall be applicable only on the Tuition Fee for the concerned academic year.
- b) A student shall be eligible for only one scholarship in a given academic year.
- c) All types of Scholarships shall be valid only for the concerned academic year.
- d) Renewal of any type of scholarship is not automatic and shall be governed by the terms and criteria as mentioned in this policy.
- e) The number of Scholarships to be awarded under each type and sub-category for the concerned academic year shall be solely decided by the Board of Management on the recommendation of the University Scholarship Committee.
- f) A student who has been selected for a scholarship shall provide a joint (with parent) undertaking.

The scholarship shall be terminated and the scholarship amount shall be returned to the University, in case of the following violations;

- i) Any information provided in the scholarship application form is found to be untrue or fraudulent;
- ii) Found guilty and penalized under any disciplinary action;
- iii) Withdraws/discontinues studies at the University (The withdrawal process shall not be completed unless the scholarship amount is fully returned).

Further, such a student shall not be eligible to re-apply for any University scholarship.

5.6 Scholarship Process

a) During Admissions:

- i) Eligible candidates may submit the scholarship application form with all relevant documents to the admission office.
- ii) The University Scholarship Committee shall scrutinize and shortlist candidates to be interviewed by the Committee.
- iii) The award of scholarship shall be recommended by the University Scholarship Committee for the approval of the Vice Chancellor.
- iv) The decision of the Vice Chancellor shall be final.

b) During the Program:

- i) The University Scholarship Committee shall invite applications at the commencement of an academic year for the Academic Performance Scholarships which are awarded based on performance during the previous academic year.
- ii) The committee shall also invite applications for renewal of Enabling, Encouraging Scholarships which was provided at the time of admissions and the same shall be subject to review by the Scholarship Committee.

The committee shall recommend the list of scholarship awardees to the Vice Chancellor for approval and the decision of the Vice-Chancellor shall be final.

SECTION - III

ACADEMIC REGULATIONS

Amended Academic Regulations approved in the 6th Meeting of the Academic Council held on July 29, 2025 vide Resolution No 6.16.

Academic Calendar

- 1.1. The academic activities of the University are regulated by the Academic Calendar approved by the Academic Council and notified by the University at least one calendar month before the commencement of each academic year.
- 1.2. An academic year in the University shall normally be divided into two semesters consisting of ninety (90) University working days each, known as 'Odd Semester' (normally from July / August to December) and 'Even Semester' (normally from January to April/May).
- 1.3. An additional Academic Term known as the 'Summer Term' may be scheduled during the summer break (June to July).

2. Registration

- 2.1. Every student shall complete the mandatory requirement known as the 'Registration' procedure and register for the prescribed and approved Courses to be pursued during a given Academic Term. This Registration process is mandatory every Semester / Academic Term till the completion of the Program. The University Registrar's Office manages the registration process and related activities.
- 2.2. The prescribed date for Registration shall be announced in the Academic Calendar and through notifications issued by the University to this effect.
- 2.3. The Chairperson of the Program Academic Committee (PAC) of each Program/School shall communicate the list of approved/prescribed Courses available for Registration in the concerned Semester to the University Registrar's Office for Notification as per the specified dates in the Academic Calendar.
- 2.4. Every student after consulting their Faculty Advisor [Mentor] is required to register for the approved Courses offered in the given Academic Term at the commencement of each Semester/Academic Term on the days fixed for such registration as notified in the Academic Calendar or the University Notification to this effect.

On joining the University, each student is assigned a Faculty Advisor [Mentor] to counsel the student on matters related to the Registration process.

- 2.5. Without registration, any academic activity (Course / Internship / Project, etc.) undergone by a student will not be counted towards the requirements for the award of the Degree. No student shall be permitted to attend classes without completing the appropriate registration procedure.

2.6. Late registration shall only be permitted in case of medical exigencies, specifically hospitalization, trauma or contagious diseases, for the student / family member, and participation in approved competitions/events as detailed in Sub-Clauses 2.6.1 and 2.6.2. below. In such cases, a student may be permitted for late registration with prior approval from the concerned Program Chair / Dean of the concerned School. In the absence of Program Chair / Dean of the concerned School, the authorised faculty shall approve.

2.6.1. In cases of medical exigency (viz. hospitalization, trauma or contagious disease only), for the student / family member, the maximum period permissible for late registration shall not be more than two (02) calendar weeks counted from the specified date of Registration announced by the University. The student must produce the medical certificates, medical prescriptions, hospital discharge report, medical fitness report and all such relevant documents duly attested by the concerned registered medical officer of the hospital where the concerned student / family member was hospitalized or medically treated. The student shall not be eligible for late registration if they fail to produce authentic medical certificates and relevant documents in support of the medical exigency.

2.6.2. If a student of second and subsequent semesters has been selected / permitted by the University to participate in State / National / International Competitions / Events, the concerned student may be permitted for late registration. The student must produce duly attested documents and/or Certificates to be eligible for the provision of late registration. The number of days for which the concerned student shall be given permission for late registration shall be approved by the Vice Chancellor on recommendation of both the Director, Campus Life and Program Chair of the concerned school.

2.7. In case of any other reason for late registration other than the cases specified in Sub-Clauses 2.6.1 and 2.6.2 above, the maximum permissible period for late registration shall not be more than one (01) calendar week counted from the specified date of Registration announced by the University.

Further, the student shall pay a Late Fee for late registration as specified by the University at the commencement of the Academic Term. No

relaxation whatsoever shall be given on attendance requirement in case of late registration. Under no circumstances shall such a student be permitted to register for the Academic Term after the permissible period for late registration of one (01) calendar week counted from the specified date of Registration.

- 2.8. Further, the provisions mentioned in Clauses 2.6 and 2.7 are applicable only for registration at the commencement of a Semester and does not apply for the Summer Term (Refer Section 11).
- 2.9. Students are not permitted to re-register for Courses which they have already passed, except under the provisions and conditions of Clauses 11.4.3 and 12.5.
- 2.10. A student shall be permitted to register in the next Semester only if all the following conditions are fulfilled:
 - 2.10.1. The student has paid all specified fees of the University as per the University Fee Policy and payment schedule.
 - 2.10.2. The student has cleared all University, Hostel, Transport and Library dues (if any).
 - 2.10.3. The student has not been debarred from registering on any specific grounds by the University.
- 2.11. Further, the student must fulfil the progression criteria prescribed in Clause 12.1 to register for the Semester at the commencement of the concerned Academic Year.
- 2.12. A student who is eligible for registration, but fails to register for the Academic Term within the specified dates, including the late registration date, shall be removed from the rolls for the concerned Academic Term and shall not be permitted to attend classes for the concerned Academic Term. Such a student shall have to register for the corresponding Academic Term in the next academic year.
- 2.13. Pre-Registration (Specialization / Minor / Open and other specified Courses) for higher Semesters:

All students (other than the students admitted to the first Semester of a Program) intending to register for the next higher Semester are required to complete the Pre-Registration process. A student, after consultation with the Faculty Advisor [Mentor], is required to declare their intent to

register for Specialization / Minor / Open and any other specified Courses, as/if applicable, well in advance, before the actual start of the concerned Academic Term, through the process of Pre-Registration as per the schedule/dates announced in the Academic Calendar and/or the notifications issued by the University to this effect. Specialization / Minor courses will be offered only if a minimum of ten (10) students register for the same. However, the program chair may permit to offer the courses at their discretion.

2.14. Course Pre-Requisites

For a student to register for some Courses, it may be required either to have exposure in, or to have completed satisfactorily, or to have prior earned credits in some specified Courses. Such Course pre-requisites shall be specified in the concerned Program Regulations / Course Plan as approved by the PAC.

2.15. Changes in Registration: Add/Drop

Students may add and drop Courses after consulting the concerned Faculty Advisors [Mentor] and submit a request for add/drop to the concerned Program Chair/Dean of Schools within two weeks of commencement of classes for add/drop.

On approval, the Course(s) shall be added, and the dropped Course(s) will not appear on the Grade Card (Refer Clause 8.14).

Student may seek transfer from one Program to another before the commencement of registration for the Second Year with due approval of both Program Chairs, subject to the eligibility criteria and provisions of the academic regulations. On no account shall a transfer from one Program to another be allowed beyond the stipulated period.

2.16. A student of a particular degree Program shall register for the appropriate number of Course credits in each Semester/session that is within the minimum and maximum limits specific to that degree Program as stipulated in the Program Regulations.

2.17. Audit a Course

Auditing a Course is a provision for a student who may opt to register for a Course to acquire knowledge / skills, but not to earn credits and grade points.

A student who desires to register for auditing a Course shall consult their Faculty Advisor [Mentor] and seek approval of the concerned Course

Instructor (Refer Clause 8.1). Registration shall only be permitted as per the criteria and guidelines prescribed by the concerned Course Instructor and duly approved by the concerned PAC. The student only earns a “S” [satisfactory] **OR** “U” [unsatisfactory] for Audited Course.

Audited Courses shall not count towards completing the degree requirements. In the event that the student secures a U grade in an audit course, which is non mandatory, it will be deemed that such a student has discontinued the course. The U grade will not be reflected in the transcript.

3. Academic Credits - Course Credit Structure

The Credit Structure is used to define various types of Courses to provide for the appropriate pedagogy and methods of assessment and evaluation. The flexibility required to accomplish the Course learning objectives and outcomes can be provided for, while retaining a common framework for Credit allocation. More importantly, it is necessary to have a transparent, credible and robust system for planning, delivery and evaluation of each Course of the diverse Programs of study of the University.

- 3.1. The Credit Structure for defining and categorizing Courses is the L – T – P (Lecture – Tutorial – Practical) framework. The Course Credits are fixed based on the following norms:

Lecture / Tutorial: One (01) contact/classroom hour per week is assigned One (01) Credit.

Practical: Two (02) hours per week of practice/studio/laboratory/field and other similar practice or skill development components, are assigned One (01) Credit.

For example:

A Course with L – T – P structure of 4 – 0 – 0 will be assigned 4 Credits.

A Course with L – T – P structure of 3 – 1 – 0 will be assigned 4 Credits.

A Course with L – T – P structure of 0 – 0 – 4 will be assigned 2 Credits.

A Course with L – T – P structure of 1 – 0 – 4 will be assigned 3 Credits.

- 3.2. Practice/Skill based Courses like Industry Internship, Capstone, Research Dissertation, Integrative Studio, Interdisciplinary Project and such similar Courses, and Non-Taught Credit Courses like Seminar, Summer / Short Internship, Social Engagement / Field Projects and such similar Courses, where the pedagogy does not lend itself to a typical L-T-P structure as defined in Clause 3.1, are assigned the number of Credits based on the quantum of work/effort required to fulfil the learning objectives and outcomes prescribed for the concerned Courses.

- 3.3. A student earns credits by satisfactorily completing Courses and other academic activities every Academic Term. The credits associated with a Course are dependent upon the number of hours of instruction per week in that Course. Similarly, the credit associated with any of the other learning activities is dependent upon the quantum of work expected to be put in for each of the other learning activities. In general, a certain quantum of academic work measured in terms of Credits is laid down as the minimum requirements for the award of a particular Degree.

4. Program Regulations

The Program Regulations is a set of Program specific regulations, as applicable, and the Program Curriculum for the concerned Degree Program. The Program Regulations shall be recommended by the concerned Board of Studies for approval of the Academic Council and shall include the following details:

- 4.1. Program specific regulations with respect to admission criteria, Program duration, mandatory minimum credit requirements for the award of the Degree, assessment and evaluation guidelines/criteria, and any other regulations mandated by concerned Government Regulatory Bodies, where applicable, for the specific Program of study.

The concerned Program Regulations shall provision, as applicable, for various types and title / nomenclature of qualifications. as per the guidelines outlined by the University Grants Commission (UGC). Further, the Program Regulations shall specify the process of recommendation and approval for the award of such qualifications.

- 4.2. The Program Structure and Curriculum with the list of Courses offered for the Program of study, with the associated Credit/s for each Course.

5. Medium of Instruction and Evaluation

English shall be the medium of instruction and evaluation.

Any other language, if required for a specific Course (or Courses), shall be proposed by concerned Board of Studies and approved by the Academic Council and Board of Management of the University.

6. Maximum Duration for the Completion of a Program

- 6.1. The permissible maximum duration (number of academic years) for completion of a Program (Undergraduate and Postgraduate) shall be (N+2) years, where N is the normal duration (number of academic years) as prescribed by the concerned Program Regulations.

- 6.2. The enrolment of the student who fails to complete the mandatory requirements for the award of the concerned Degree (Refer to Section 15) in the prescribed maximum duration, shall stand terminated and no Degree shall be awarded.
- 6.3. The time taken by the student to improve Grades/CGPA, and in case of temporary withdrawal/re-joining (Refer to Clause 13.1), shall be counted in the permissible maximum duration for completion of a Program.

7. Attendance Requirements

- 7.1. In order to maintain academic rigour and excellence, all students must attend every lecture, tutorial, studio, field work, laboratory, practical classes and all other such curricular sessions as prescribed by the Program requirements.
- 7.2. To account for approved leave of absence to appear for end semester examination, the attendance requirement shall be a minimum of seventy five percent (75%) of the classes actually conducted in every Course the student has registered for in the Academic Term.
- 7.3. Further, if a student or their family member/s suffer serious medical exigencies of hospitalization, trauma or contagious disease, the concerned student may submit a leave request, together with documents to the Faculty Advisor [Mentor] for recommendation to the Program Chair. The student shall be given an additional relaxation in attendance in the Course(s) where there is a shortage subject to the approval by the Vice-Chancellor. However, on no account whatsoever, shall the minimum requirement of attendance be less than sixty five percent (65%) of the classes actually conducted in every Course the student has registered for in the Academic Term. The student shall not be eligible for this special provision if they fail to produce authentic medical certificates and relevant documents, including fitness certificate (in the case of student only), on the day of rejoining the classes, in support of the medical exigency.
- 7.4. If a student has been selected to represent the State and/or India in State / National / International Events / Competitions, the concerned student may be given relaxation in attendance requirement (in the Course(s) where there is a shortage) for the concerned period of absence recommended by the Director, Campus Life and the Faculty Advisor [Mentor] to the Program Chair and thereafter approval by the Vice Chancellor. However, on no account whatsoever, shall the minimum requirement of attendance be less than sixty five percent (65%) of the classes actually conducted in every Course the student has registered for in the Academic Term. The student shall not be eligible for this special provision if they fail to produce authentic certificates of participation in the aforementioned Events / Completions.

7.5. Further, where attendance requirements are prescribed by Government Regulatory Bodies for specific Programs, the same shall also be mandatorily adhered to without exception. Such specific requirements, as applicable, shall be prescribed in the Program Regulations of the concerned Program of study.

7.6. Shortage of Attendance:

A student with shortage of attendance (as specified in Clause 7.2 and the applicable provisions of Clauses 7.3, 7.4 and 7.5) shall not be permitted to appear for the End Term Examinations, as applicable, of the Course(s) in which the attendance shortfall exists, irrespective of the student's academic performance in the final components of Continuous Assessments. The student shall be declared as having failed to complete the Course due to shortage of attendance and shall be given the 'FA' Grade (Refer to Sub-Clause 8.13.3) in the concerned Course(s).

The student is cautioned that shortage of attendance may result in the loss of an Academic Year. It is the sole responsibility of the student to ensure that they do not fall under shortage of attendance.

8. Teaching, Evaluation and Grading System

8.1. Courses from the approved Program Structure may be offered during any Academic Term. Each approved Course, whenever offered in any given Academic Term, shall be conducted by the assigned Course Instructor.

8.2. The Course Instructors and Tutors/Teaching Assistants, if any, for all the Courses to be offered by the School/Department during any Academic Term shall be assigned by the concerned Program Chair/Dean of School.

8.3. The Course Plan, prepared by the assigned Course Instructor, for every Course that is offered in a given Academic Term shall be approved by the concerned Program Chair and BoS.

8.4. The Course Instructor shall be responsible for conducting the Course, conducting the assessments and examinations, evaluating the performance of the students and awarding the grades at the end of the Academic Term.

8.5. The academic performance evaluation of a student in a Course shall be according to the University Letter Grading System based on the class performance distribution of the Course.

8.6. Academic performance evaluation of every registered student in every Course registered is done through various components of Continuous Assessments spread across the Semester and including the End Term Examinations. The nature of components of Continuous Assessments and

the weightage given to each component of Continuous Assessments, including the End Term Examinations, shall be prescribed in the Program Regulations of the Program concerned.

8.7. Evaluation System: Components and Weightage

The University shall follow a Course Instructor led continuous evaluation system. The components and recommended weightages of the evaluation system are summarized in Table 1 below:

<i>Table 1. Evaluation System: Components and Weightage</i>		
<i>Type of Course Structure</i>	<i>Evaluation Components</i>	<i>Weightage</i>
Lecture-based Course L in the L-T-P Structure predominates (Examples: 3-0-0; 2-1-0; 3-0-2; etc.)	Continuous Assessments	60% (minimum) to 70% (maximum)
	End Term Examination / Comprehensive	30% (minimum) to 40% (maximum)
Practice-based Course P in the L-T-P Structure predominates (Examples: 0-0-4; 1-0-4; 1-0-2; etc.)	Continuous Assessments	70% (minimum) to 100% (maximum)
	End Term Examination / Jury / Project / Viva Voce	30% (maximum)
Practice/Skill based Courses like Industry Internship, Capstone project, Research Dissertation, Integrative Studio, Interdisciplinary Project and such similar Courses, and Non-Taught Credit Courses like Seminar, Summer / Short Internship, Social Engagement / Field Projects and such similar Courses, where the pedagogy does not lend itself to a typical L-T-P structure (Refer Clause 3.2)	Guidelines for the components of evaluation for the various types of courses, with recommended weightages / criteria for assessing the components, shall be specified in the concerned Program Regulations and Course Plans, as applicable.	

8.8. The Course Instructor shall communicate clearly to the students through the approved Course Plan, and other announcements as required at the commencement of the Academic Term in which the Course is offered, the details of the evaluation system with components of evaluation and the

associated weightage with each of the components, including the distribution of the weightage for each of the components.

8.9. Grading is the process of rewarding the students for their overall performance in each Course. The University follows the system of Relative Grading to classify the students based on their relative performance in the concerned Course. Absolute Grading may be used in case the number of students registered in the concerned Course is less than ten (10). The Course Instructor shall declare the manner of grading in such instance. Grading shall be done at the end of the Academic Term by considering the aggregate performance of the student in all components of Continuous Assessments prescribed for the Course. Letter Grades shall be awarded to a student based on her/his overall performance relative to the class performance distribution in the concerned Course. These letter grades not only indicate a qualitative assessment of the student's performance but also carry a quantitative (numeric) equivalent called the Grade Point.

8.10. Letter Grading System

The University follows the system of Letter Grades with associated Grade Points on a Scale of 10. The Letter Grades and Associated Grade Points are summarized in Table 2:

Table 2. Letter Grades with Grade Points and Brief Qualitative Description		
Letter Grade	Grade Point	Qualitative Description
O	10	Outstanding
A ⁺	9	Excellent
A	8	Very Good
B ⁺	7	Good
B	6	Above Average
C	5	Average
D	4	Pass
F	0	Fail
FA	0	Fail - Shortage of Attendance
S	–	Satisfactory
U	–	Unsatisfactory
I	–	Incomplete

8.11. Earned Credits

This refers to the credits assigned to the Courses in which a student has obtained either 'S' grade (in other than Audit Courses), or any one of the grades 'O', 'A+', 'A', 'B+', 'B', 'C', 'D' (but not 'F' or 'FA').

8.12. Cut-off Marks for 'O' and 'F' Grades

The cut-off marks for 'O' grade and for 'F' grade (aggregate of the marks assigned for components of Continuous Assessments, and the marks assigned for the End Term Examination, as applicable), will be decided by the Course Instructor based on the specific relevant details of the class performance distribution (using appropriate class performance statistics parameters). However, as a general guideline, the minimum cut-off marks for 'O' and 'F' grade shall be 85% and 35% respectively. In exceptional cases, where the 'O' or 'F' grade is proposed below the aforementioned minimum cut-off marks, the concerned Course Instructor shall provide justification for the same to the concerned Program Chair, subject to the approval by the Statutory Grading Approval Committee before the respective grades are awarded.

The minimum/maximum cut-off marks for the intermediate grades are determined by the Course Instructor using appropriate partitioning/clustering method based on the specific relevant details of the class performance distribution.

8.13. Description of Grades:

8.13.1 'O' Grade

An 'O' grade stands for outstanding achievement, relative to the class, and the Course Instructor shall take utmost care in awarding this highest grade.

8.13.2 'D' Grade

The 'D' grade stands for marginal performance and is the minimum passing grade.

8.13.3 'F' and 'FA' Grades

- a) The 'F' grade denotes very poor performance, i.e., failure in a Course due to poor performance and the Course Instructor shall take utmost care while awarding this lowest grade.

Further, 'F' grade shall be given to a student who is Absent for the End Term Examination as specified for a concerned Course. If the

absence is solely due to medical exigencies specifically hospitalization, trauma or contagious disease only, the placeholder Grade 'I' will be given (Refer Sub Clause 8.13.5).

- b) 'FA' grade denotes poor attendance i.e., failure in a Course due to attendance shortage (Refer Clause 7.6).
- c) The students who have received 'F' grade in a Course in the immediate subsequent semester may be allowed to appear for a Make-Up Examination. The Make-Up Examinations will be conducted possibly along with that arranged for those students who received the 'I' grade, within the period announced in the Academic Calendar.
- d) Only regular registrants of a given Course during a given Academic Semester who have obtained 'F' or 'I' grade in the Course will be permitted to appear for the Make-up Examination.
- e) Students who continue to have 'F' grade after the Make-Up Examination are required to re-register for the Course whenever it is offered subsequently.
- f) All the 'F' and 'FA' grades secured in any Course shall be recorded on the grade card.
- g) A student who obtains 'FA' grade in any Course shall re-register for the Course in the subsequent Academic Term whenever the Course is offered until a passing grade is obtained. However, for a course that is not mandatory in which 'FA' grade has been obtained, the student may either repeat the same Course or register for any other Course (from the list of approved Courses). The student is permitted to opt for change of Minor only once till completion of the program.

8.13.4 'S' and 'U' Grades

- a) Grades 'S' and 'U' do not have any associated grade points and are recommended for use in the evaluation of select Non-Taught Credit Courses [Summer Internship], as applicable, and for grading Audit Courses.
- b) The 'S' grade denotes satisfactory performance and completion of a Course. The associated credits are earned and counted for the mandatory credits requirements as specified in the concerned Program Curriculum.
- c) The 'U' grade denotes unsatisfactory performance and non-completion of a Course. The student shall have to re-register for

the concerned Course, if mandatory, until the 'S' grade is awarded. This clause is also applicable to Audit Courses.

- d) In the event that the student secures a U grade in an audit course, which is non mandatory it will be deemed that such a student has discontinued the course. The U grade will not be reflected in the transcript.
- e) The 'S' or 'U' grade secured in a Course shall be recorded on the Grade Card.

8.13.5 'I' Grade

'I' is a placeholder grade which denotes "incomplete" performance in any Course or Courses, due to one of the following conditions:

- a) Absence at the End Term Examination solely due to medical exigencies, specifically hospitalization, trauma or contagious disease. The 'I' grade shall be replaced by an appropriate letter grade after the student clears the Make-Up Examination (Refer Clause 9.4).
- b) In case of a reported case of unfair means (plagiarism, malpractice, etc.) under investigation against a student in the End Term Examination or any component of assessment of any Course(s), the student will be given an I Grade. The placeholder grade 'I' shall be replaced with a regular grade based on recommendations of the panel constituted to investigate the case, and the subsequent approval of the Registrar. Students will not be eligible for the Make-up examination if the investigating panel recommends a 'F' grade.

The Course(s) in which a student has received 'I' grade shall not be included in the SGPA/CGPA calculations (Refer Clause 8.15).

8.14. Grade Card:

A Grade Card for an Academic Term is the record of the student's performance in the Courses the student has registered for in that Academic Term of the Program of study.

The Grade Card shall contain the following details pertaining to the student's academic performance:

- a) The List of Courses (which includes Course Name, Course Code and associated Credits) registered for by the student in the concerned Academic Term [Semester], Make-Up Examinations and Summer Term as applicable;
- b) The Grade obtained in each of the concerned Courses; and,

- c) The SGPA and CGPA obtained by the student.
- d) Transcript will be issued on completion of the Program.

8.15 Transcript:

A **University Transcript** is an official academic document that comprehensively records a student's academic progress throughout their time at the university. It also serves as a formal reference for determining eligibility to receive the degree certificate during convocation. The transcript provides detailed information on every course a student has registered for and successfully completed, including the **Course Code, Course Title, Grade Obtained, Credit, Semester of Completion**, and **Course Bucket** (e.g., University Core, Program Foundation, etc.).

The **Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA)** is computed based solely on courses that carry grade points. However, the following rules apply:

- **Mandatory courses** graded as **S (Satisfactory)** or **U (Unsatisfactory)** are listed in the transcript but are excluded from CGPA calculation, as they do not carry grade points.
- **Audit courses** are included only if the student earns an '**S**' grade. If a '**U**' grade is received in an audit course, it is omitted from the transcript.
- If a student **fails to complete a course** in the original semester but later completes it through re-registration, only the most recent valid grade is recorded.
- Courses from which a student has **formally withdrawn** do not appear in the transcript.
- In case a student opts to exit before completion of the degree program, the transcript will be issued upon request with all grades obtained by the student at that point of time.

In addition, the transcript outlines the **mandatory credit requirements** fulfilled by the student across key academic categories such as **University Core, Program Foundation, Program Core, Specialization**, and **Minor**.

8.16 Evaluation of Performance: SGPA AND CGPA

The overall academic performance of a student shall be measured by two indices: SGPA which is the “Semester Grade Point Average” and CGPA which is the “Cumulative Grade Point Average.”

SGPA

The performance of a student in a Semester is indicated by a number,

Semester Grade Point Average. The SGPA is the weighted average of the grade points secured in all the Courses registered for by the student during that Semester. SGPA for a particular Semester (and Summer Term, as applicable) is computed as follows:

$$\text{SGPA} = \frac{\sum_{k=1}^n [C_k \times G_k]}{\sum_{k=1}^n C_k}$$

where:

n is the number of Courses (with Letter Grades and Grade Points, including the Letter Grades 'F' and 'FA', which have zero grade points) registered for by the student in the Semester concerned;

C_k is the Credits assigned to Course k and G_k is the Grade Point received by the student for the Course k .

CGPA

The Cumulative Grade Point Average indicates overall academic performance of a student in all the Courses registered for up to and including the latest completed Semester. CGPA is computed as follows:

$$\text{CGPA} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^n [C_i \times G_i]}{\sum_{i=1}^n C_i}$$

where:

n is the number of Courses (with Letter Grades and Grade Points, including the Letter Grades 'F' and 'FA', which have zero grade points) registered for by the student up to, and, including the latest completed Semester/Academic Term;

C_i is the Credits assigned to Course i and G_i is the Grade Point received by the student for the Course i .

8.17 The SGPA and CGPA are calculated to two (02) decimal places.

9. Examinations

9.1. Continuous Assessments includes components such as Quiz, Presentations, Take Home Assignments, Group Discussions etc., which are spread across the Semester. The nature of components of Continuous Assessments and the weightage given to each component shall be mentioned in the respective Course Plan. In case a student misses any component of the continuous assessment, except the final continuous

assessment, it is up to the discretion of the course instructor to offer an extended deadline or alternative assignment, but before the academic term ends. Final component of Continuous assessment shall be conducted after ascertaining the attendance requirement.

- 9.2. The detailed schedule of the End Term Examinations, as per dates indicated in the Academic Calendar, shall be prepared by the Registrar (Evaluation) in consultation with the Program Chairs/Deans of Schools and shall be announced with due approval of the Vice Chancellor, at least one (01) calendar month before the commencement of the End Term Examinations.
- 9.3. The detailed schedule of the Make-Up Examinations, where applicable, shall be published by Registrar (Evaluation) in consultation with the Program Chairs/Deans of Schools and shall be announced with due approval of the Vice Chancellor, at least two (02) calendar weeks before the commencement of the Make-Up Examinations.
- 9.4. The rules and guidelines pertaining to the conduct of the various University Examinations shall be notified by the Registrar (Evaluation) after due approval of the Registrar and the Vice Chancellor.
- 9.5. Make-Up Examinations

Make-Up Examinations are a provision for a student to complete a Course (or Courses) in which she/he received an 'F' grade or was given the placeholder grade 'I' to reappear in the End Term Examination component of a Course (or Courses), subject to the conditions mentioned below in Sub-Clauses 9.5.1 and 9.5.2. Students may also avail the benefit of Make-up examination to improve her/his CGPA. In no other circumstances shall Make-Up Examinations be available to students.

- 9.5.1 A student who fails to appear for the End Term Examinations in some or all Courses due to medical exigencies, specifically hospitalization, trauma or contagious disease and the said student informs the Program Chair/Dean concerned in a timely manner (i.e., on or before the commencement of the said End Term Examinations), may submit a request to the Registrar [Evaluation] of the University within the duly notified dates, along with the prescribed fee for the Make-Up Examinations fixed by the University from time to time. On the basis of the student's performance in the Make-Up Examinations and considering the marks obtained by the student in all other

Continuous Assessments, as applicable, the final letter grade awarded shall replace the placeholder grade 'I'.

In case, the application of the student for Make-Up Examinations is rejected by the Registrar [Evaluation], the student shall be declared "Failed" in the concerned Course(s) and the placeholder grade 'I' shall be replaced with 'F' grade in the concerned Course(s). Further, the student shall have to complete the Course(s) as per the provisions and conditions prescribed in Clause 11 and Sub-Clause 11.4.2.

Further, if the concerned student does not avail the Make-Up Examinations, or is absent for the Make-Up Examinations, the student shall be declared "Failed" in the concerned Course(s) and the placeholder grade 'I' shall be replaced with 'F' grade. Further, the student shall have to complete the Course(s) as per the provisions and conditions prescribed in Clause 11 and Sub-Clause 11.4.2.

9.5.2 Any student may avail the benefit of Make-up examination to improve her/his CGPA or to enable her/him to satisfy the progression criteria as prescribed in Section 12. The student shall submit the registration form for the Make-Up Examinations for approval to the Registrar (Evaluation) of the University within the duly notified date, along with the prescribed fee for the Make-Up Examinations fixed by the University from time to time.

Further, if a student registers for the Make-up examination, the existing grades obtained in the concerned Course(s) shall be declared null and void, unless the student secures a lower grade in the Make-up examination. These shall be replaced by grades the student receives in the concerned Course(s).

9.5.3 The provision of Make-Up Examinations shall not be available for Practice / Skill based Courses based and Non-Taught Credit Courses as described in Clause 3.2. If a student has secured an 'F' Grade in such a Course, the student shall complete the concerned Courses by repeating them in the Semester when they become available for registration. Further, the student is cautioned that she/he shall have to register for the concerned Course(s) only in the concerned Semester of the next Academic Year when the concerned Course(s) shall be offered, which may result in the loss of an Academic Year for the student. It is the sole responsibility of the student to ensure that she/he completes the Course(s) and/or earns

the required credits as prescribed by the concerned Program Regulations.

10. Academic Appeals

- 10.1. The University is committed to keep the entire process of evaluation transparent. Within three (03) working days of announcement of results, if a student needs clarification on the marks / grade obtained, the Course instructor shall explain to a student why they received the grade awarded. A mechanism for review of grades is incorporated in the evaluation system.
- 10.2. The student may appeal for review of grades to the AAB [Academic Appeal Board] before the date specified in the Academic Calendar or notification issued by the University to this effect.
- 10.3. The fee for such an appeal shall be notified by the University from time to time.
- 10.4. The AAB shall submit its report and recommendation to the Vice Chancellor within five (05) University working days from the date of appeal. The approval and decision of the Vice Chancellor shall be final and binding on all concerned. The decision of the Vice Chancellor, to change or retain the awarded grade, shall be duly notified and effected accordingly by the Registrar (Evaluation).

11. Summer Term

- 11.1. The Summer Term is an additional Academic Term that may be offered during the summer break, typically for about eight (08) weeks during June-July. The minimum number of teaching days in the Summer Term shall be thirty (30) days.
- 11.2. Though the Courses offered in the Summer Term are delivered in a shorter term, the total number of contact hours for these Courses remain as per the Course Credit Structure. The Course contents/syllabus and the continuous assessments and evaluation patterns for these Courses also remain the same as that prescribed by the concerned Program Regulations.
- 11.3. The details of the registration process for the Summer Term shall be announced on the dates scheduled in the Academic Calendar or through a University Notification.

11.4. A limited number of Courses may be offered in the Summer Term with the following special provisions:

11.4.1. A student may re-register for the Course(s) by paying the prescribed fee, if offered, in which the student had received the grade 'FA', to complete these Course(s) and earn the required credits;

11.4.2. A student may re-register for the Course(s) by paying the prescribed fee, if offered, in which the student had received the 'F' grade in earlier Semesters, to complete these Course(s) and earn the required credits;

11.4.3. A student may re-register for the Course(s) by paying the prescribed fee, if offered, in which the student had received lower grades in earlier Semesters, to improve her/his performance and secure higher grades in these Course(s) and improve the CGPA to enable her/him to satisfy the criteria for progression as prescribed in Clause 12.1. Further, if a student re-registers for a Course (or Courses), the existing grades obtained in the concerned Course(s) shall be declared null and void, unless the student secures a lower grade in the repeated course. These shall be replaced by grades the student receives (after evaluation at the end of the Summer Term) in the concerned Course(s).

11.5. A student may register for the Summer Term Course(s), subject to all the conditions stated below:

11.5.1. A student who wishes to register for the Summer Term must complete the registration process on or before the last date for Registration as specified in the Academic Calendar or the University Notification to this effect. No late registration shall be permitted.

11.5.2. A student shall remit the Summer Term Registration Fee per Course, as prescribed by the University from time to time, within the date specified for payment.

11.5.3. A student can register for a maximum of 12 credits / 280 hours.

11.5.4. Attendance requirements as prescribed in Clause 7.2 shall be applicable to all students registering for Course(s) in the Summer Term.

11.5.5. A student cannot request or demand for a specific Course to be offered.

11.5.6. In the event that less than ten (10) students are willing to register for a Course in the summer term, the Program Chair is the competent authority, based on the merit of the case, to consider whether or not to offer the Course.

11.5.7. Further, the student,

- a) must have paid/cleared all the required fees/dues as applicable for the Summer Term; and,
- b) has not been debarred from registering on disciplinary or other grounds.

12. Progression

12.1. To facilitate academic progression towards timely completion of the Program of study and fulfilling the requirements for the award of the Degree, the minimum CGPA criteria for yearly promotion of a student to the next Academic Year is summarized in Table 3 below:

<i>Table 3: Progression Criteria</i>	
Progression Stage	Minimum CGPA Requirement
Progression to Year 2 of the Program	Minimum CGPA of 4.00 (Eligibility Criteria to Register for Semester 3)
Progression to Year 3 and higher years of the Program	Minimum CGPA of 5.00

12.2. The Minimum CGPA Requirement as specified above is after considering the results at the end of the concerned Semester, Make-Up Examinations and Summer Term, as applicable.

12.3. Further, if a student is not eligible for progression to the next Academic Year of the Program of study due to not fulfilling the criteria stipulated in Clause 12.1 above, he/she/they shall choose one of the provisions specified in Clauses 12.4 and 12.5 below to continue with the Program of study.

- 12.4. The student may opt to repeat the concerned Academic Year (both Odd and Even Semesters) of the Program of study:

The student may opt to repeat the corresponding Academic Year of the Program of study, in the next Academic Year of the University by registering in the concerned Odd Semester for all the concerned Courses and by registering in the following Even Semester for all the concerned Courses prescribed by the concerned Program Regulations.

- 12.4.1. Further, if a student opts for the provision of repeating the concerned Academic Year of the Program of study, the credits earned, as applicable, and Grades previously obtained in all the Courses registered in the concerned Academic Year of the Program of study, shall stand withdrawn and declared null and void, unless the student secures a lower grade in the repeated course.

- 12.4.2. Further, the student shall remit the Annual University Fee prescribed by the University for the concerned Program of study and clear any other dues, to be eligible to register in concerned Academic Year.

- 12.5. Alternatively, a student may opt to re-register in the next Academic Year (in the Odd Semester, Even Semester or both Semesters, as required) for only the specific Courses to earn the mandatory Credits and the CGPA required for promotion to the following Academic Year:

- 12.5.1. A student may opt to re-register for only some select Courses among those offered in the concerned Odd/Even Semester in the next Academic Year (as prescribed by the concerned Program Regulations), as per her/his choice to earn the required mandatory credits and improve her/his CGPA to be eligible for promotion to the following Academic Year.

- 12.5.2. Further, if a student opts for this provision of re-registering for select Courses, the credits earned, as applicable, and Grades previously obtained in these concerned Courses, registered in the concerned Semester(s) of the Program of study, shall stand withdrawn and declared null and void, unless the student secures a lower grade in the repeated course.

- 12.5.3. Further, the student shall remit the Annual University Fee prescribed by the University for the concerned Program of study and clear any other dues, to be eligible to register in concerned Academic Year.

13. Withdrawal/Re-joining

13.1. Temporary Withdrawal:

A student who has been admitted to a Degree Program of the University may be permitted to withdraw temporarily, for a period of one Academic Year, on the grounds of prolonged illness or grave calamity in the family, etc., provided:

- 13.1.1. The student submits an application to the University, stating fully the reasons for withdrawal together with supporting documents and endorsement from her/his parent/legal guardian;
- 13.1.2. The University is satisfied that, without counting the period of withdrawal, the student is likely to complete the requirements for the award of the Degree of the concerned Program within the specified maximum duration to complete the Program (Refer to Section 6.0).
- 13.1.3. A student seeking temporary withdrawal shall not claim any refund of the University Fee paid to the University for the concerned Academic Year.
- 13.1.4. There are no outstanding dues with the School/Hostels/Library/etc.
- 13.1.5. Scholarship holders are bound by any scholarship rules applicable to them.
- 13.1.6. Normally, a student will be permitted only one such temporary withdrawal during his/her/their tenure as a student.

13.2. Re-joining the Program

A student who temporarily withdraws from the Program (Clause 13.1) and re-joins the Program in the following Academic Year, shall be governed by all the Regulations of the University and the University Fee Structure in force at the time of his/her/their re-joining the Program.

13.3. Permanent Withdrawal

Rules pertaining to withdrawal of admission at the time of joining the University are as specified in the admission procedures and Fee Policy of the University.

In case of a student seeking withdrawal from the Program of study after completion of one or more Semesters / Academic Years, the procedures and conditions specified in the concerned Program Regulation and the Fee Policy of the University shall be adhered to.

The decision of the Registrar and the Vice Chancellor regarding all aspects of withdrawal of a student from the Program of study shall be final and binding.

14. Transfer of Credits

The Courses credited elsewhere, in recognized Indian or Foreign University/Institutions by students during their study period at the University, may count towards the credit requirements for the award of Degree. The guidelines for such transfer of credits are as follows:

- 14.1. Students may earn external credits from Institutions of National Importance and other Indian or Foreign Universities/Institutions with which the University has an MoU and that MoU shall have specific provisions, rules and guidelines for transfer of credits.
- 14.2. Students may earn credits by registering for Online Courses offered by National Program on Technology Enhanced Learning (NPTEL), Study Web of Active Learning by Young and Aspiring Minds (SWAYAM) or other such recognized Bodies/ Universities/ Institutions, as approved by the concerned BoS from time to time. The concerned PAC / shall publish/include the approved list of Courses and the rules and guidelines governing such transfer of credits from time to time. Such student/s shall mandatorily submit the course completion certificate / examination results.
- 14.3. In other cases (i.e., other than the cases mentioned above in Clauses 14.1. and 14.2) of transfer of credits sought by a student, the “Credit Transfer Equivalence Committee” constituted by the Vice Chancellor shall assess the application of the student for transfer of credits. This committee shall submit its recommendations to the Vice Chancellor through the Registrar for approval.
- 14.4. The maximum number of credits that can be transferred by a student shall be limited to forty percent (40%) of the minimum credit requirements specified by the concerned Program Regulations for the award of the concerned Degree.

15. Award of Degree

15.1. The award of the Degree shall be recommended by the Registrar [Evaluation] to the Academic Council for approval. The Academic Council shall submit its recommendations for the approval to the Board of Management and Board of Governors of the University.

15.2. A student shall be declared to be eligible for the award of the concerned Degree if she/he fulfils all the conditions prescribed in the Sub-Clauses below:

15.2.1. Fulfilled the Minimum Credit Requirements [for three years / four years / five years] and all other mandatory requirements as prescribed by the concerned Program Regulations for the award of concerned Degree;

15.2.2. Secured a minimum CGPA of 5.00 in the concerned Program at the end of the Semester/Academic Term in which she/he completes all the requirements for the award of the Degree as specified in concerned Program Regulations;

15.2.3. Paid all dues to the University, Schools, Hostels, Library, and any other such Centre's / Departments of the University; and

15.2.4. No disciplinary action is pending against the student.

15.3. Award of Distinction

A student who secures a CGPA of 8.50 and above, in the concerned Program at the end of the Semester/Academic Term in which the student completes all the requirements for the award of the Degree, shall be eligible for the award of the Degree with Distinction.

15.4. Provisional Degree Certificate

On completion of the requirements for the award of the Degree as prescribed in Clause 15.2, the student may apply for a *Provisional Degree Certificate* in the prescribed application form, along with the prescribed Fee notified by the University from time to time, to the Registrar of the University.

On verification of the eligibility criteria, the Registrar [Evaluation] shall issue the *Provisional Degree Certificate* to the concerned student, to the effect that the concerned student has fulfilled all the requirements for the

award of the Degree in the concerned Program, and that, the Degree shall be conferred on the concerned student at the next Convocation of the University.

16. Convocation

The Convocation of the University shall be held annually as per the Convocation Regulations of the University. The University shall announce the date for the Convocation and call for applications from eligible students to register for the Convocation. The duly completed application form must be submitted and the prescribed Convocation Fee must be paid by the student to the University within the specified date announced by the University.

Degrees shall be awarded in person at the Convocation for the students who have graduated during the preceding Academic Year. Degrees shall be awarded in absentia to such students who are unable to attend the Convocation.

17. Power To Revise, Modify and Amend

17.1. The Academic Council has all rights to revise, amend or modify any of the above Regulations from time to time and these modified Regulations shall be binding on all parties concerned.

17.2. Notwithstanding anything stated in these Regulations, for any unforeseen issues arising, and not covered by these Regulations or in case of difficulty in application of any of the Sections / Clauses of the Regulations specified above, the Vice Chancellor shall have the powers to amend / modify / remove the difficulty in the relevant Regulation.

Section – IV

Code of Conduct

Code of Conduct

1. Introduction

The Vidyashilp University Student Code of Conduct is a set of standards of conduct expected of students during their tenure as students of the University.

The aim of the University is to sculpt '*vidya*' (education) and not the student. In Sanskrit, it is said that '*vidya dadati vinayam*', meaning, that education imparts character. The aim, therefore, is reflective of the need for students to learn values such as respect for fellow beings as well as display civility and inclusiveness in their behavior towards other students, faculty, research scholars and support staff.

At VU, the various Schools function with an interdisciplinary interdependence. Diversity in thinking and using a pluralistic approach to learning is something that is replete in the University system. A VU graduate must inculcate a sense of reverence for the knowledge derived from other domains.

The VU curriculum is structured such that, along with domain knowledge the students must learn aspects of citizenship, sportsmanship and concern for the environment.

2. Unique “VU Experience”

The essence of Vidyashilp University is to create a unique “VU Experience” – an enjoyable journey of learning from one another and learning together through intentional collaboration between individuals and groups from diverse cultures and backgrounds.

VU’s purpose is to create a diverse, inclusive community and environment where faculty, staff, students and parents, and alumni feel connected to one another by a common sense of purpose and develop a distinctive ability to lead and serve in diverse contexts.

The “VU Experience” is a collective endeavour to inculcate the “*Vidyashilp Graduate Attributes*”.

3. Attributes of a Vidyashilp Graduate

(What VU endeavors its students and alumni to BE!)

The unique “VU Experience” is a journey with an aspiration that each and every student of Vidyashilp will grow towards conscientious citizenship and exemplify the attributes of being:

- 3.1 **Self-Aware:** The student sojourn is an experience of self-discovery and self-knowledge. Explore one’s intellectual curiosity and humanity;
- 3.2 **Confident:** The self-awareness to manifest a developed sense of self-purpose and confidence to pursue one’s goals;
- 3.3 **Empathetic:** Being able to respect and appreciate other people; catalyze the free exchange of ideas in an interdependent, diverse community and explore ways to serve in harmony;
- 3.4 **Resourceful:** Take responsibility to apply knowledge, scholarship and creative practice to benefit society and the growth of the nation, and as a
- 3.5 **Leader:** Serve society with a commitment to the underprivileged and deprived in the community.

4. VU Student Code of Conduct

The Code applies to the conduct of students on campus. It also applies to their conduct off-campus and on social media, if the same is likely to have serious consequences or adverse impact on the University's interests or reputation. Further, it applies to conduct when students participate in the University’s programs or activities or such activities where the student represents the University or is deemed to be an ambassador of the University. The conduct applies to students living in residences arranged by the University too.

The Code of Conduct has been established to communicate the expectations of proper and professional conduct in line with the values and standards upheld by the founders of the University. It serves as the basis, on which, students should make decisions related to the best interests of themselves, the faculty and other staff in the University, rather than a statement of what to do or should not do while at the University.

- 4.1 Students are expected to maintain the highest standards of discipline and dignified behavior inside as well as outside the University campus. They shall abide by the rules and regulations of the University and should act in a way that highlights the discipline and esteem of the University.
- 4.2 Students are expected to maintain integrity and honesty in all their actions; whether in class during lectures, tutorials or practical sessions; while appearing

for any form of evaluation or any other co-curricular or extra-curricular activities.

- 4.3 Students are expected to be trustworthy in their actions when given any responsibility during the conduct of co-curricular or extra-curricular activity by the faculty or other university staff, by acting in a reliable and dependable manner.
- 4.4 Students are expected to treat others with respect, civility, decency and impartiality. Any act of discrimination (physical or verbal conduct) based on gender, caste, race, religion or religious beliefs, color, region, language, disability, or sexual orientation, marital or family status, physical or mental disability, gender identity, etc. are prohibited under the Code of Conduct.
- 4.5 Students must comply with the attendance requirement of 80%. On medical grounds or other legitimate reasons, this may be reviewed as per the provisions in the Academic Regulations.
- 4.6 Students are expected to make use of academic, co-curricular and extracurricular facilities available to the optimum levels. This will enable the all-round development of their personality making them physically fit, academically competent, mentally alert and socially sensitive.
- 4.7 Students are permitted to use cell phones, laptops and other such gadgets for academic purposes on the University premises.
- 4.8 Students are expected to maintain decorum in the academic buildings and refrain from any deviant behavior such as hooting, whistling, loitering etc.
- 4.9 Students are expected to maintain decorum while posting any pictures, write-ups or notes on social media and refrain from posting anything that could in any way harm the reputation or interest of other students, faculty management or University staff or damage the reputation or the interest of the University.
- 4.10 Students are prohibited under the Code of Conduct from assaulting, harassing, intimidating, or threatening another individual or group endangering the health or safety of others.
- 4.11 Students are prohibited under the Code of Conduct from stealing, misusing, destroying, defacing or damaging University property.
- 4.12 Students are not permitted to arrange any unauthorized celebrations, distribute or display any notices or banners on the campus.

- 4.13 Students are prohibited under the Code of Conduct from using University facilities, equipment, services or computers without authorization.
- 4.14 Students are prohibited under the Code of Conduct from forging, altering or misusing any University document or record.
- 4.15 Students are prohibited under the Code of Conduct from storing, possessing or using real or replica firearms or other weapons, explosives (including fireworks), ammunition, or toxic or otherwise dangerous materials on University premises.
- 4.16 Students are prohibited under the Code of Conduct from consuming, possessing or distributing drugs, alcohol or any form of tobacco.

5. Failing to comply with this Code of Conduct will lead to and not limited to:

- a) Written warning or reprimand;
- b) Payment of costs or compensation for any loss, damage or injury caused by the conduct;
- c) Issuance of an apology, made publicly or privately;
- d) Forfeiture of Scholarship, where applicable;
- e) Restriction or prohibition of access to, or use of, University facilities, services, activities or programs;
- f) Suspension and or expulsion from the University

Section – V

Guidelines on Banning Ragging and Anti-Ragging Measures

Guidelines on Banning Ragging and Anti Ragging Measures

1. Introduction

Pursuant to the directives of the Honourable Supreme Court of India and in accordance with the UGC Regulations, on curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, 2009, the University is committed to ensuring no ragging takes place by instituting stringent anti-ragging measures and provisions for strict punishments to defaulters. Ragging is a cognizable offence and Vidyashilp University will take strict action against offenders.

2. Definition of Ragging

The University considers the definition of ragging as per UGC's "Curbing the menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions (third amendment), Regulations, 2016" which states that:

" Any act of physical or mental abuse (including bullying and exclusion) targeted at another student (fresher or otherwise) on the ground of color, race, religion, caste, ethnicity, gender (including transgender), sexual orientation, appearance, nationality, regional origins, linguistic identity, place of birth, place of residence or economic background."

The University educates the students enrolled in various programs at the beginning of each academic year about the Anti-Ragging Policy and zero tolerance for ragging at the University.

Each student, as well as his/her parents/ guardian, are mandatorily required to submit separate undertakings in the form of an affidavit at the time of admission to the effect that they are aware of the prohibition of ragging and the punishment prescribed both under penal laws as well as under these regulations.

Anti-ragging hoardings, banners, and billboards are displayed at prominent places on the University campus, including hostels, canteens, messes, cafeterias, buses, playgrounds, lawns, labs, etc.

Surprise checks of hostels/canteens/cafeterias/bus stops are carried out regularly. A close and regular liaison is maintained with the local police to guard against the

incident of ragging. FIR will be lodged in the police station on all reported ragging cases.

Daily briefing of freshers is carried out by counsellors and coordinators. An anti-ragging committee of the students is also formed.

In case any student encounters ragging by any of the senior students, he/she is immediately required to contact the members of the anti-ragging committee, who will take immediate corrective action and necessary proceedings will be initiated against the culprits engaged in ragging activities.

3. Prohibition of Ragging

- 3.1 Ragging within the University Campus including its Institutions / Departments and Hostels is strictly prohibited.
- 3.2 Ragging in any form is prohibited also in the private lodges/buildings where these University students are staying.
- 3.3 Ragging in any form is prohibited in Hostel, Mess, Canteen, Cafeteria & Transport (University & Private).
- 3.4 No person including students/staff/faculty shall participate or abet or propagate ragging in any form

4. Punishment for Ragging

- 4.1 Lodging FIR against the offender.
- 4.2 Rigorous Imprisonment for up to 3 years (under the court of law).
- 4.3 Fine up to Rs. 2, 50,000/-.
- 4.4 Expulsion from Vidyashilp University and consequent debarring from admission to any other institution.

5. General Instructions

5.1 Anti-Ragging Committees

- a) University shall form an “Anti-Ragging Committee” headed by the Chairperson, appointed by the Vice Chancellor. It will comprise selected faculty members, parents, students from the fresher’s category as well as seniors and selected non-teaching staff.

- b) This Committee will be fully and totally responsible to ensure that no incidence of ragging as given in this regulation takes place and will also monitor and ensure that the instructions of this regulation are followed fully at all times.
- c) The Committee will also maintain alert vigil at all times and ensure that the Anti-Ragging Squads of the Institution carry out their functions properly.

5.2 Anti-Ragging Squads

- a) The Chairperson of Anti Ragging Committee will constitute a number of Anti-Ragging Squads. The number of squads will be based on the number of blocks/floors and the strength of the students so that the Anti-Ragging Measures can be effectively implemented.
- b) Anti-Ragging Squads will comprise of senior faculty members and responsible representatives of senior students and freshers. Its function will include going around / patrolling the Department and the Campus common areas, maintaining vigil at all times on all days by rotation as decided by Director/Deputy Director/Programme Coordinator and taking action if they notice any incidence of ragging either in their Department, any other Department or on the Campus.
- c) The Squads will also have the responsibility to investigate incidences of ragging and to report to the Anti-Ragging Committee for immediate action/punishment wherever required.
- d) Director/Deputy Director/Programme Coordinator will forward the names of Anti-Ragging Committees and Anti-Ragging Squads to the University Anti-Ragging Monitoring Cell.
- e) On the report of the Anti-ragging Squad or any other person who witnesses the incidence of ragging or on the complaint of any fresher student, immediate action will be taken by the Anti-Ragging Committee to decide appropriate punishment from the list of punishments in the Regulation and award it with intimation to the University Administration.

6. Action Procedure

- 6.1 Anti-Ragging Squads will immediately report any incidence of ragging or abetment of ragging noticed by them to the Anti-Ragging Committee of each Department.
- 6.2 Faculty in charge of the Anti-Ragging Committee will take immediate action as per the situation which may include:
 - a) Immediate suspension of involved students
 - b) Sending reinforcements or any medical help if required.
 - c) Forward the main gist/report of the incident to the Anti-Ragging Committee.
- 6.3 The Anti-Ragging Committee of the concerned Department will examine the report and recommend appropriate punishment with intimation to the University Administration.

7. Anti-Ragging affidavit

To ensure a safe and conducive learning environment for all students at Vidyashilp University, it is mandatory for every student to fill the Anti-Ragging affidavit.

Steps to fill the Anti Ragging Affidavit in UGC

- 7.1: Visit the website: <https://www.antiragging.in/>
- 7.2: Navigate to the “Form” tab and select ‘Register for Undertaking’
- 7.3: Under the “ Education Institution Type’, Choose ‘ University’
- 7.4: Fill in your personal details and provide the necessary information for your Parent’s / Guardian’s details.
- 7.5: Select ‘State’ as ‘ Karnataka’ and ‘Vidyashilp University(U-1197) as the University Name.
- 7.6: Please refer to the following table for details regarding the University

University Code	U-1197
University Name	Vidyashilp University
University Director’s Name	Dr P.G. Babu
University Phone Number	8951792369
Details of the Course	Under Graduate Degree
Name of the Course	(Mention your Program)
Number of Students in your class	(Mention the number of students in your batch)
Current Year of Study	(Mention Your current year)
Nearest Police Station	Chapparkallu Police Station

After submitting the form, you are required to download two forms: ‘Undertaking/Affidavit by the student’ and ‘Undertaking/ Affidavit by the parent’. Please save copies of these forms for uploading on the student registration platform at a later stage. Additionally, kindly ensure that you submit the duly signed (Student and Parents) hard copies of these forms to the office of Registrar during course registration at the campus.

Section – VI

Guidelines on Prevention of Sexual Harassment

Guidelines on Prevention of Sexual Harassment

1. Introduction

The Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 ("POSH Act") was enacted as a comprehensive legislation to provide a safe, secure and enabling environment, free from sexual harassment to every woman. This statute was enacted to fill the legislative void which had been partially addressed by the judiciary in *Vishaka and Others v. State of Rajasthan and Others* (1997 (7) SCC 323). In this seminal public interest litigation verdict, the Supreme Court of India had framed a set of guidelines ("Vishaka Guidelines") for dealing with instances of sexual harassment at the workplace, which has now been codified in the POSH Act.

The Supreme Court of India held that sexual harassment of women is a violation of the fundamental right of women to work in a safe environment.

The Supreme Court has defined 'sexual harassment' to include:

- 1.1 "An unwanted conduct with sexual undertones if it occurs or which is persistent and which demeans, humiliates or creates a hostile and intimidating environment or is calculated to induce submission by actual or threatened adverse consequences and includes any one or more or all of the following unwelcome acts or behavior (whether directly or by implication), namely; -
 - a) any unwelcome physical, verbal or non-verbal conduct of sexual nature;
 - b) demand or request for sexual favours;
 - c) making sexually colored remarks
 - d) physical contact and advances; or
 - e) showing pornography
- 1.2 any one (or more than one or all) of the following circumstances, if it occurs or is present in relation or connected with any behavior that has explicit or implicit sexual undertones-
 - a) implied or explicit promise of preferential treatment as quid pro quo for sexual favors;
 - b) implied or explicit threat of detrimental treatment in the conduct of work;
 - c) implied or explicit threat about the present or future status of the person concerned;
 - d) creating an intimidating offensive or hostile learning environment;

- e) humiliating treatment likely to affect the health, safety dignity or physical integrity of the person concerned;

As a follow-up to the POSH Act, the University Grants Commission (UGC) – the apex body for all higher education institutions - has come up with a regulation titled University Grants Commission (Prevention, prohibition and redressal of sexual harassment of women employees and students in higher educational institutions) Regulations, 2015. These regulations apply to all higher education institutions in India. The provisions of the regulation are being adhered to by Vidyashilp University.

2. Responsibility of the University

VU commits to a zero-tolerance policy against sexual harassment. The management reinforces that it will create a campus free from discrimination, harassment, retaliation or sexual assault at all levels. VU will ensure compliance with all provisions of the regulation and make the following efforts toward the same:

- a) Constitute an **Internal Complaints Committee** to proactively curb all forms of harassment of employees and students.
- b) Publicly notify the provisions against sexual harassment and ensure their wide dissemination in the prospectus, notice boards as well as the website, the penalty and consequences of sexual harassment.
- c) Organise training programmes/ workshops for the officers, functionaries, faculty and students, as indicated in the SAKSHAM Report (Measures for Ensuring the Safety of Women and Programmes for Gender Sensitization on Campuses) of the UGC, to sensitize them and ensure knowledge and awareness of the rights, entitlements and responsibilities enshrined in the Act and under these regulations. These include sessions to create awareness about what constitutes sexual harassment including hostile environment harassment and quid pro quo harassment
- d) Act decisively against all gender-based violence perpetrated against employees and students of all sexes.
- e) Bring to book those guilty of sexual harassment against its employees and students.
- f) Monitor the timely submission of reports by the ICC as well as prepare an annual status report with details on the number of cases filed and their disposal and submit the same to the Commission.

3. Constitution of ICC

VU has established an Internal Complaints Committee to prevent, prohibit and redress and issues of sexual harassment. The ICC constitutes a lady presiding officer who is a senior teaching faculty member, 2 other teaching faculty members, 2 members from the non-

teaching, 3 students and an external member who works for an association that is committed to the cause of women.

4. Role of ICC

- a) provide assistance if an employee or a student chooses to file a complaint with the police;
- b) provide mechanisms or dispute redressal and dialogue to address issues through a just and fair conciliation without undermining the complainant's rights, and minimize the need for purely punitive approaches that lead to further resentment, alienation or violence ;
- c) protect the safety of the complainant by not divulging the person's identity, and provide the mandatory relief by way of sanctioned leave or relaxation or attendance requirement or transfer to another department or supervisor as required during the pendency of the complaint, or also provide for the transfer of the offender;
- d) ensure that victims or witnesses are not victimized or discriminated against while dealing with complaints of sexual harassment; and
- e) ensure the prohibition of retaliation or adverse action against a covered individual because the employee or the student is engaged in protected activity.

5. How to lodge a complaint?

An aggrieved person is required to submit a written complaint to the ICC within three months from the date of the incident and in case of a series of incidents within a period of three months from the date of the last incident.

The Presiding Officer or any Member of the ICC shall render all reasonable assistance to the person for making the complaint in writing.

6. Process and timeline of conducting an inquiry

- a) The ICC shall, upon receipt of the complaint, send one copy of the complaint to the respondent within a period of seven days of such receipt.
- b) Upon receipt of the copy of the complaint, the respondent shall file his or her reply to the complaint along with the list of documents, and names and addresses of witnesses within a period of ten days.
- c) The inquiry has to be completed within a period of ninety days from the receipt of the complaint. The inquiry report, with recommendations, if any, has to be submitted within ten days from the completion of the inquiry to the Vice Chancellor of VU. Copy of the findings or recommendations shall also be served on both parties to the complaint.

- d) The Vice Chancellor shall act on the recommendations of the committee within a period of thirty days from the receipt of the inquiry report unless an appeal against the findings is filed within that time by either party.
- e) An appeal against the findings or /recommendations of the ICC may be filed by either party before the Vice Chancellor within a period of thirty days from the date of the recommendations.
- f) The aggrieved party may seek conciliation in order to settle the matter. No monetary settlement should be made as a basis of conciliation. The conciliation process shall be facilitated through the ICC
- g) The identities of the aggrieved party or victim or the witness or the offender shall not be made public or kept in the public domain, especially during the process of the inquiry.

7. Action against offenders

- a) Anyone found guilty of sexual harassment shall be punished in accordance with the service rules of VU if the offender is an employee.
- b) Where the respondent is a student, depending upon the severity of the offence VU may
 - i) withhold privileges of the student such as access to the library, auditoria, halls of residence, transportation, scholarships, allowances, and identity card;
 - ii) suspend or restrict entry into the campus for a specific period;
 - iii) expel and strike off the name from the rolls of VU, including denial of readmission, if the offence so warrants;
 - iv) award reformatory punishments like mandatory counselling and, or, the performance of community services.

8. Action Against False or frivolous Complaints

To ensure that the provisions for the protection of employees and students from sexual harassment do not get misused, provisions against false or malicious complaints have to be made. If the ICC concludes that the allegations made were false, malicious or the complaint was made knowing it to be untrue, or forged or misleading information has been provided during the inquiry, the complainant shall be liable to be punished.

Section – VII

Ombudsperson

Ombudsperson

The Ombudsperson at Vidyashilp University will take on the onus of making recommendations to students, faculty, staff, and the University leadership on matters that are referenced to his office. In addition to counselling complainants, the Ombudsperson will also advise them on resolving their issues through means within and outside the University. He will provide confidential counsel and guidance to the Vidyashilp community members as an external person with no conflict of interest.

Members of the Vidyashilp community are encouraged to connect with the Ombudsperson if an issue has not been satisfactorily resolved through the University's existing processes.

The Ombudsperson's primary responsibility is to promote the well-being of students, faculty, and staff. This includes offering a confidential and secure environment for individuals to voice their concerns related to harassment, inappropriate behavior, unprofessional conduct, abuse of power, termination of service, and restrictions on freedom of expression according to university policies. The Ombudsperson will guide both members of the University community and the institution in resolving such disputes.

Form for Appeal to Ombudsperson is available in the University's Website

Please complete this form and submit a signed copy through email to ombudsperson@vidyashilp.edu.in

Section – VIII

DRESS CODE

VU STUDENT CODE FOR HIGHER LEARNING, PERSONAL EXCELLENCE AND PROFESSIONALISM

VU aims to maintain an environment conducive to academic growth, higher learning, and professional relationships. VU expects its students to maintain and uphold the highest standards of integrity and honesty at all times and embrace community standards, diversity, inclusivity and mutual respect for one another, both within the University and the community. The University strives for a professional environment free of safety risks, offensive behaviour, and harassment of any kind.

In furtherance to the above, the VU Student Code of Conduct, the *Policy Against Sexual Harassment*, and giving due respect to the allied laws, the *VU Student Code for Higher Learning, Personal Excellence and Professionalism*, provide the students with an overview of the attire of the University. The Code is a benefit and intends to help and route the manner of student attire in the University and in its activities based on common sense and good judgment of the environment they are in, guided by a professional attitude toward others in the University, its visitors, and the public.

The following provides the students with a general overview of the *VU Student Code for Higher Learning, Personal Excellence and Professionalism* of the University:

1. **Value and credit for Higher Learning and Professional Presentation:** The University believes that students are free to express their individuality through their appearance and that it paves the way for them to unearth themselves. However, the University discourages such expressions that would disrupt the possibilities of higher learning and professionalism.
2. **Smart Casual Attire:** Students are encouraged to choose attire that reflects professionalism and respect for the learning environment. The environment is professional; therefore, the attire, even if comfortable, must adhere to the business/smart casual policy.

The following classifications provide a clear student image:

Do wear:

- Business or Casual shirts (collared, button down, short or long-sleeved shirts) or sleeveless shirts or blouses, if business appropriate or suitable for the professional environment.
- Ethnic dresses, if business appropriate or suitable for the professional environment.
- Blazers, sweaters, cardigans, turtlenecks, stoles, scarves and hats/caps are used for comfort according to the climate.
- Casual bottoms, khakis, dress pants, pants or slacks, skirts, and other bottom wear should be business-appropriate or suitable for the professional environment.
- Suits, sports coats, and ties are optional, provided they are suitable for the professional environment.
- Dress shoes, including high or open-toed heels, walking shoes, and sneakers, should be business-appropriate or suitable for the professional environment.

Do wear (with restrictions):

- Polo t-shirts or other t-shirts (without - holes, profanity, alcohol or drug references, or inappropriate or offensive slogans or images).
- Jeans (not excessively worn, ripped, frayed, torn, holes, etc.).

3. **Hygiene, Grooming and Appearance:** Students are encouraged to maintain good personal hygiene standards, where their overall appearance reflects the standards of professionalism and respect expected at VU.

- Students must practice general personal hygiene standards.
- Students must always appear well groomed, including styling their hair and facial hair.
- Use deodorants, perfumes or colognes to maintain a comfortable environment for all.
- Students must ensure that their clothes are clean and neat.
- Students must ensure that what they wear is suitable for the activities of the day, that they feel comfortable and safe in them, and that they are not unsuitable for an environment of learning.

4. **Representations of the University Externally:** Students are expected to uphold the University's reputation, reflecting professionalism and respect, when representing the University outside the campus. Towards this, students participating in external competitions/events/fests representing the University must ensure that they follow good personal hygiene standards, a formal dress code or smart casuals appropriate for a professional environment.
5. **Internships:** Students interning at institutions outside the University or Virtually (online), irrespective of whether the University arranges the internship opportunity or otherwise, must ensure they follow good personal hygiene standards, a formal dress code or smart casuals appropriate for a professional environment.
6. **Interviews:** Students appearing before external interview panels (outside or virtually (online)) must ensure they follow good personal hygiene standards, a formal dress code or smart casuals appropriate for a professional environment.
7. **Formal Gatherings at the University:** Students are expected to follow a formal dress code or smart casuals that reflect the seriousness and importance of the occasion at all Academic Events, presentations, and formal gatherings organised by the University.
8. **Informal Events:** For all the informal events organised by the University for the Students within the University premises, the Office of Student Affairs will release a "Dress-Down" if necessary.
9. **Compliance and Enforcement:** All students of the University must adhere to the *VU Student Code for Higher Learning, Personal Excellence and Professionalism*. Any violation of the above prescribed Code may result in the student being required to leave the campus by any faculty/ staff/office bearers of the University. While doing so, the student will be directed to return to the University in attires that are business-appropriate or suitable for the professional environment or adequately groomed, as the case may be.

Section – IX

MALPRACTICE IN EXAMINATION HALL

Vidyashilp University believe in creating the ethos of learning centric, fair and transparent evaluation. Student are expected to adopt this ethos and help in building this culture in the University. However, Vidyashilp University has zero tolerance towards any type of following activities which are considered as malpractice.

Case 1	Possession or accessibility of materials such as paper, notebooks, programmable calculators, etc., related to the examination subject but not utilized during the exam, including any marks on the candidate's body that could aid in the exam.
Case 2	The student tries to give or receive assistance during the examination orally or by any use of body language but is unsuccessful and has been noticed by the invigilator for the first time.
Case 3	Possession or accessibility of cell phones, smartwatches, computers, etc., during the examination.
Case 4	Gives assistance or receives it orally or by any other body language methods from any other candidate inside or outside the examination hall.
Case 5	Communicates through cell phones with any candidate or other persons in or outside the exam hall in respect of any matter.
Case 6	Has copied in the examination hall from any paper, book, programmable calculators, palm computers, smartwatch, Mobile phone or any other form of material relevant to the subject of the examination (theory or practical) in which the candidate is appearing.
Case 7	Impersonates any other candidate in connection with the examination.
Case 8	Smuggles in the Answer book or additional sheet or takes out or arranges to send out the question paper during the examination or answer book or additional sheet, during or after the examination.
Case 9	Uses objectionable, abusive or offensive language in the answer paper or in letters to the examiners or writes to the examiner requesting him to award pass marks.
Case 10	Refuses to obey the orders of the Registrar Evaluation / Dy Registrar Evaluation/ Invigilator /any officer on duty or misbehaves
Case 11	The student creates disturbance of any kind in and around the examination hall, for e.g. organizes a walk out or instigates others to walk out of the examination hall; vandalises and destroys objects inside or outside the examination hall.
Case 12	The student threatens the Registrar of Evaluation or any person on duty in or outside the examination hall of any injury to his person or to any of his relations whether by words, either spoken or written or by signs or by visible representation, verbal ally or physically assaults the Registrar of Evaluation or any person on duty in or outside the examination hall or any of his relations,
Case 13	Leaves the exam hall taking away answer script or intentionally tears of

	the script or any part thereof inside or outside the examination hall.
Case 14	Possess any lethal or non-lethal weapons or firearms in the examination hall.
Case 15	If student of the University, who is not a candidate for the particular examination or any person not connected with the University indulges in any malpractice or improper conduct.
Case 16	Found with the influence of alcohol or any narcotic elements the examination hall.
Case 17	Copying detected on the basis of internal evidence, such as, during evaluation or during special scrutiny.
Case 18	Mass malpractice that involves more than one student in an act suggestive of a collectively pre-planned malpractice.

If any students involved in any form of malpractice shall

1: Be stopped from writing the respective examination.

2: Appear before the Malpractice Enquiry Committee formed by the Vice Chancellor

Vice Chancellor shall form the Malpractice Enquiry Committee to investigate the malpractice cases under the supervision of the Registrar. Malpractice Enquiry Committee may recommend to award F Grade for the respective course or debar for a semester or debar for a year or rusticate from the University based on the intensity of the malpractice action by the student

If any malpractice is detected which is not covered in the above clauses 1 to 18, Vice Chancellor shall decide appropriate action based on the recommendation of Malpractice Committee and Registrar.

If any malpractice is detected which is not covered in the above clauses 1 to 18, Vice Chancellor shall decide appropriate action based on the recommendation of Malpractice Committee and Registrar.

Section – X

KNOWLEDGE RESOURCE CENTRE (KRC)

Vidyashilp University Library-KRC offers a wide range of resources, including print and e-books, journals and e-journals, magazines and e-magazines, newspapers and e-newspapers, as well as audio-visual materials. It provides access to top-notch e-resources through subscriptions to online databases for full-text articles from the national and international journals and magazines.

General Guidelines

- KRC users are expected to maintain silence at all times in the KRC. Group discussions are strictly not allowed inside the KRC.
- While entering the KRC, all are required to enter his/her name in the Register indicating entry and exit timings with signature.
- Personal items (e.g., books, mobile phone, folders, files, blazers, jerkins, overcoats, etc.) are not allowed in the KRC and should be kept at the belongings' counter at the KRC entrance. The KRC is not responsible for any loss / damage of your articles.
- Vidyashilp University faculty, staff, and students are eligible to become members of the KRC.
- Students are required to display their University ID cards while entering the KRC and at any time when requested by the KRC staff.
- Books or journals removed from the shelves should not be replaced but should be left on the table.
- Users should not mark, underline, or write in the KRC books, periodicals, and newspapers.
- Computers kept in the Digital KRC Section are only meant for academic research / study purposes.
- All KRC users are requested to read the emails/noticeboard for latest updates.
- Talking over the Cell-phone is strictly prohibited inside the KRC. However, if any one wish to carry the phone with him/her, must be kept in silent mode. Violating this norm is viewed seriously.
- Eatables and beverages are strictly not allowed inside the KRC.
- Students are requested to maintain the university dress code in the KRC.
- At the end of every semester, students should clear all KRC dues, if any.
- All students are required to strictly adhere to the above guidelines and cooperate with the KRC staff for the smooth and efficient functioning of the KRC.

Section – XI

SPORTS POLICY

Sports policy is crucial for fostering physical health, social cohesion, and economic growth within a society. By promoting regular physical activity, it helps combat lifestyle-related diseases and enhances mental well-being. It encourages inclusivity and social integration, ensuring equal access to sports for all, while instilling values like teamwork and discipline among youth. Economically, sports policy generates jobs, boosts local economies through sports tourism, and stimulates infrastructure investment.

It also enhances national pride by supporting elite athletes and fostering success on the international stage. Ensuring fairness and safety in sports, it promotes lifelong participation, contributing to overall life quality and community well-being.

1. Objectives:

- **Enhance Physical Health:** One of the main goals is to encourage everyone in the university community to engage in regular physical activity. By doing so, we aim to improve the overall health and well-being of all students, faculty, and staff. Regular exercise can lead to better physical fitness, increased energy levels, and improved mental health.
- **Boost Participation:** Another important objective is to increase the number of people participating in sports and recreational activities. We want to create more opportunities for everyone to get involved, whether they are beginners or experienced athletes. By boosting participation, we hope to create a more active and engaged university community.
- **Skill Development:** We aim to provide various opportunities for students to develop and refine their sports skills. This includes offering training programs, workshops, and coaching sessions. By helping students improve their abilities, we support their personal growth and enhance their enjoyment of sports and physical activities.
- **Promote Team Spirit:** Fostering a sense of teamwork, fair play, and sportsmanship is a key focus. We want to create an environment where everyone values cooperation and respect. Through team sports and group activities, participants can learn the importance of working together, supporting each other, and competing with integrity.
- **Support Elite Athletes:** For those students who excel in their sports, we are committed to providing the necessary resources and support to help them achieve their best. This includes access to high-quality training facilities, professional coaching, and other resources that can aid in their athletic development. By supporting elite athletes, we help them reach their full potential and represent the university with pride.

2. Scope

This policy is comprehensive and applies to every individual who is part of the Vidyashilp University community, which includes students, faculty, and staff members. It encompasses all sports and recreational activities that are organized, sponsored, or endorsed by the university. This broad scope includes a variety of activities, ranging from intramural competitions, where members of the university compete against each other, to intercollegiate contests, which involve competition with other educational institutions. Additionally, the policy covers fitness programs designed to promote health and well-being among participants,

as well as informal recreational activities that may not be part of a structured program but still fall under the university's purview. Whether you are engaging in a competitive sport, participating in a fitness class, or simply enjoying a casual game or exercise session on campus, this policy is designed to ensure a safe, inclusive, and well-regulated environment for all involved. It underscores the university's commitment to fostering a vibrant and active community through diverse and accessible athletic and recreational opportunities.

3. Sports Programs and Activities:

3.1 Intramural Sports:

- **Overview:**

At VU, our intra-sports tournaments have consistently provided memorable experiences for all participants. Alongside our flagship events like the Vidyashilp Premier League, a cricket tournament having multiple teams with students, faculties and staff from the campus which included a mandatory faculty/staff and a female player in the playing XI. This was also extended to Vidyashilp Academy and the Century Real Estate Group, The success of these events not only showcased the competitive spirit but also highlighted the strong sense of sportsmanship among all participants, making each tournament an unforgettable occasion.

- **Sports Offered:**

The sports which have been offered to the students are Football/Futsal, Basketball, Volleyball, Cricket, Badminton, Swimming, Tennis, Table Tennis, Frisbee, Billiards, Carrom board and various board games Swimming.

3.2 Intercollegiate Sports

- **Overview:**

We offer a variety of team and individual sports options tailored to our students' interests, ensuring they receive proper training and skill development. Selection for these sports will follow a process established by the Director of Campus Life.

For example, we have conducted a Brotherhood Cricket Tournament, an intercollegiate friendly match played with a leather ball in collaboration with Vidyashilp Academy. This event was a significant addition to our sporting calendar, fostering a spirit of camaraderie and sportsmanship among the participating colleges. The tournament was not just an opportunity for friendly competition but also served as an important selection process for our cricket team.

3.3 Recreational Activities:

We provide an array of recreational pursuits, encompassing activities like yoga, aerobics, various dance forms, and more, thereby affording students the opportunity to delve into diverse interests. Due to the current lack of comprehensive facilities at our founding campus, Vidyashilp Academy, these recreational activities are conducted on-site. Students, faculty, and staff are offered the flexibility to choose a specific day from the timetable for their participation, ensuring convenient access to these enriching experiences.

4. Facilities

- **Sports Complex:**

The campus prides itself on its extensive repertoire of sports facilities, which encompass both indoor and outdoor spaces. Among these are meticulously maintained basketball courts, futsal arenas, and volleyball courts, each designed to cater to a diverse array of sporting interests and preferences. These facilities serve as more than mere venues for physical activity; they foster a vibrant culture of athletic engagement and personal development within the campus community. By providing ample opportunities for students to participate in sports and recreation, the campus endeavors to promote holistic well-being and a balanced lifestyle among its members.

We are currently using Vidyashilp Academy's state-of-the-art sports facilities for student training. Initially, we began training at the Dravid Padukone Academy, our Center of Excellence, while the Vidyashilp Academy facilities were under construction. Starting in January 2024, we have been utilizing Vidyashilp Academy for all sports training, practice, and selection trials.

5. Code of Conduct:

- **Sportsmanship:**

In the realm of sportsmanship, participants are entrusted with the responsibility of embodying a comprehensive set of values that extend beyond mere competition. Central to this ethos is the unwavering commitment to respect, fairness, and integrity in every facet of engagement. Respect entails not only acknowledging the abilities and efforts of opponents but also embracing diversity and inclusivity within the sporting community. Fairness demands equitable treatment, where adherence to rules and regulations ensures a level playing field for all involved.

- **Safety:** It is of utmost importance that all individuals within the specified environment prioritize and strictly adhere to established safety protocols and guidelines, while also ensuring meticulous attention to the correct and proper usage of equipment, as this plays an indispensable role in safeguarding against potential hazards and ensuring the well-being and security of everyone involved.

- **Inclusivity:** Fostering an inclusive environment that actively encourages and welcomes participation from individuals of diverse skill levels, genders, and backgrounds is essential. By embracing inclusivity, we not only create a space where everyone feels valued and respected but also harness the collective strengths and perspectives of a diverse group.

- **Disciplinary Actions:** The involvement of a disciplinary committee means that instances of misconduct can lead to serious consequences, such as suspension or expulsion from participation in activities.

6. Support and Development

- **Financial Support:** Subsidies for travel, equipment, and competition fees.

7. Health and Safety

- **Medical Support:** On-site medical facilities and personnel available during sports events.
- **Injury Management:** Clear protocols for the prevention and management of injuries.
- **Mental Health:** Access to mental health support services for athletes.

8. Contact Information

- **Sports Office:** B3-03, 3rd floor B-Block, Vidyashilp University, Bangalore-562110.

9. Conclusion

Vidyashilp University is dedicated to fostering an inclusive and dynamic sports culture that enhances the physical, mental, and social well-being of its community. This policy outlines our commitment to providing ample opportunities, resources, and facilities for everyone to engage in sports and physical activities.

Important Contact Numbers

1	Director - Campus Life	9823385284
2	Finance Officer In-Charge	8792915048
3	Deputy Registrar (Examination & Evaluation)	7204176753
4	Assistant Registrar (Academic)	8792489795
5	Associate Director – Residential Life & Co-ordinating Officer	9845143102
6	Coordinator – Administration & Facilities	8951184991
7	Student Activities Co-ordinator	8105058750

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